

UNIT - I

WRITING SKILLS

Q1. (a) Explain about a well-structured paragraph using appropriate signpost words and cohesive devices.

A **well-structured paragraph** presents one main idea clearly and logically. It contains a **topic sentence, supporting sentences, and a concluding sentence**. Signpost words and cohesive devices help connect the ideas smoothly.

Structure of a Well-Structured Paragraph

1. **Topic Sentence** - Main Idea of the paragraph
2. **Supporting Sentences** - Explain, describe, or provide examples for the main idea.
3. **Concluding Sentence** - Summarizes the main idea.

Signpost Words

Signpost words guide the reader through the ideas.

Examples:

- **Addition:** also, furthermore, moreover, in addition
- **Contrast:** however, but, on the other hand
- **Cause and Effect:** therefore, thus, because, as a result
- **Example:** for example, for instance
- **Conclusion:** finally, in conclusion, to summarize

Cohesive Devices

Cohesive devices connect sentences and ideas together.

Examples:

- **Pronouns:** it, they, this, these
- **Conjunctions:** and, but, because, so
- **Repeated keywords:** repeating important terms
- **Synonyms:** using similar words to avoid unnecessary repetition

Q1. (b) Describe the role of grammar and vocabulary in improving technical communication

Grammar and vocabulary are important parts of effective technical communication. They help writers present technical information **clearly, accurately, and professionally**.

Role of Grammar

1. **Improves clarity** - Correct grammar makes the meaning of a sentence clear.
2. **Avoids misunderstanding** - Proper sentence structure prevents confusion.
3. **Creates professionalism** - Grammatically correct writing gives a professional impression.
4. **Maintains accuracy** - Correct use of tense, articles, prepositions, and sentence structure helps present technical information accurately.

Role of Vocabulary

5. **Gives precise meaning** - Technical vocabulary helps explain specific concepts accurately.
6. **Makes communication concise** - Using suitable words helps express complex ideas in fewer words.
7. **Helps the target audience** - Appropriate vocabulary makes technical information easier for the intended readers.
8. **Avoids ambiguity** - Choosing the correct technical terms reduces multiple meanings and confusion.

Example

The machine not working properly because problem in motor.

The machine is not functioning properly because the motor has a technical fault.

The second sentence uses **correct grammar and suitable vocabulary**, making the meaning clear.

Q2. Describe the significance of grammar, vocabulary, passive voice, reported speech and concord in professional technical writing.

Professional technical writing is used in **project reports, research papers, manuals, proposals and technical documents**. It should be clear, accurate, formal and easy to understand. **Grammar, vocabulary, passive voice, reported speech and concord** help make technical writing professional and effective.

1. Grammar - Grammar is the correct arrangement of words in a sentence.

Significance:

- It provides **clear sentence structure**.
- It helps communicate technical information **accurately**.
- It avoids misunderstanding and ambiguity.
- It gives a **professional impression**.
- Correct use of **tense, articles, prepositions and punctuation** improves readability.

Example:

The system monitor the temperature. (Wrong)

The system **monitors** the temperature. (Correct)

2. Vocabulary - It means the words used to communicate information.

Significance:

- Technical vocabulary gives **precise meaning**.
- It helps explain complex technical concepts.
- It makes communication **concise and clear**.
- It avoids unnecessary repetition and confusion.
- Appropriate words make the document suitable for its **target audience**.

Example:

General: The machine has a problem.

Technical: The machine has a **motor malfunction**. (Precise Information)

3. Passive Voice - In passive voice, the focus is mainly on the **action or result**, rather than the person performing the action.

Significance:

- Commonly used in **technical and scientific writing**.
- Focuses on the **process, method or result**.
- Creates an **objective and formal tone**.
- The person performing the action may not be important.
- Useful when describing experiments, procedures and processes.

Example:

Active: The researcher tested the system.

Passive: The system **was tested** by the researcher.

4. Reported Speech - Reported speech is used to present another person's **words, ideas, findings or statements** without directly quoting them.

Significance:

- Helps present information from **researchers, experts and sources**.
- Makes technical reports more formal.
- Helps summarize information from different sources.
- Avoids excessive use of direct quotations.
- Useful in **literature reviews, project reports and research papers**.

Example:

Direct speech: The researcher said, "The system is efficient."

Reported speech: The researcher **stated that the system was efficient**.

5. Concord - Concord means **agreement between different parts of a sentence**, especially between the subject and verb.

Significance:

- Ensures grammatical correctness.
- Makes sentences clear and understandable.
- Maintains agreement in **number and person**.
- Prevents grammatical errors.
- Gives technical documents a professional appearance.

Example:

The results **shows** an improvement. (Wrong)

The results **show** an improvement. (Correct)

→ Here, “**results**” is plural, so the verb “**show**” must also be plural.

Importance in Technical Writing

These five elements work together to improve technical communication:

Element	Main Purpose
Grammar	Correct and clear sentences
Vocabulary	Precise technical meaning
Passive Voice	Formal and objective style
Reported Speech	Present information from sources
Concord	Correct subject–verb agreement